

AI Photo-ID Helper

Optional identification aid

A paste-ready prompt that matches the Inventory worksheet exactly.

Version 2.0

Use this safely

- AI output is a draft, not an authentication, catalogue match or appraisal.
- Upload one clear page photo at a time and keep the original filename.
- Check the visible count against the captured quantity before pasting.
- Review every low-confidence or high-priority row yourself.

Paste-ready prompt

You are helping me inventory stamps from one uploaded photo. Analyse the stamps, not album captions, handwritten notes, printed catalogue numbers or empty placeholders.

Return one TAB-SEPARATED row per stamp, or one row per group of genuinely identical duplicates. Use exactly these 22 columns and this exact order:

stamp_id\tphoto\tposition\tcountry_as_printed\tcountry_normalized\tyear\tcurrency\tface_value\tvalue_unit\tstamp_type\tcolour\ttheme\toverprint\ton_piece\tcondition\tneeds_physical_check\tresearch_priority\tquantity\ttest_unit_value\tline_value\tid_confidence\tnotes

Rules:

1. stamp_id: create a unique ID using the photo name plus a sequence number.
2. photo: repeat the exact uploaded filename.
3. position: describe the location, for example r2c3 or upper-right.
4. year: include only when visible or confidently identified; otherwise leave blank.
5. stamp_type: use definitive, commemorative, airmail, postage due, cover, block, booklet, or other.
6. on_piece, needs_physical_check: use yes or no.
7. research_priority: use high, medium, or low. Use high for classics, colonials, overprints, errors, postal history or possible high-value items.
8. quantity: use 1 unless identical duplicates are grouped.
9. est_unit_value and line_value: leave both blank. Do not guess prices; the spreadsheet calculates line_value.
10. id_confidence: use high, medium, or low. Be honest and never guess.
11. notes: record uncertainty, possible forgery risk, unreadable text, damage, watermark/perforation/gum checks, or anything that needs human review.

After the table, separately report: visible stamp count; captured quantity total; any suspected missed/hidden stamps; and a short list of rows requiring physical inspection or expert authentication.

Put the tab-separated data in one code block with the header row first. Do not use a Markdown table.

How to paste the result

- Copy only the tab-separated code block returned by the AI.
- In Inventory, click the first empty cell in column A and paste.
- Confirm that the headers or values align across columns A through V.
- Leave line_value blank; the workbook formula calculates it.
- If everything lands in one column, use your spreadsheet's Split text to columns command and choose Tab.

Human verification checklist

Check	Why it matters
Printed country and denomination	AI can confuse album captions, cancellations and overprints with stamp text.
Quantity and hidden overlaps	Dense pages often cause missed or double-counted stamps.
Back, watermark and perforation	Front photographs are often insufficient for exact identification.
Condition	Faults, gum and hinges can change value materially.
High-value candidates	Forgery-prone material requires a catalogue check and sometimes expertisation.

Privacy reminder

Only upload images you are comfortable sharing with the AI service you choose. Check that service's current privacy and retention settings. This toolkit does not include or control an AI account.